
ABC COMPANY ORIENTATION

Joshua Schwenk
Colorado State University Global
HRM440-1: Recruitment, Selection, and Employee
Development
DR. Danielle Camacho
2/15/2026



AGENDA

8:00-10:15

- Welcome & Culture

10:30-12:00

- HR Essentials

12:00-1:00

- Lunch

1:00-2:30

- Environment & Tools

2:30-4:00

- Department Overviews

4:00-5:00

- Wrap-up

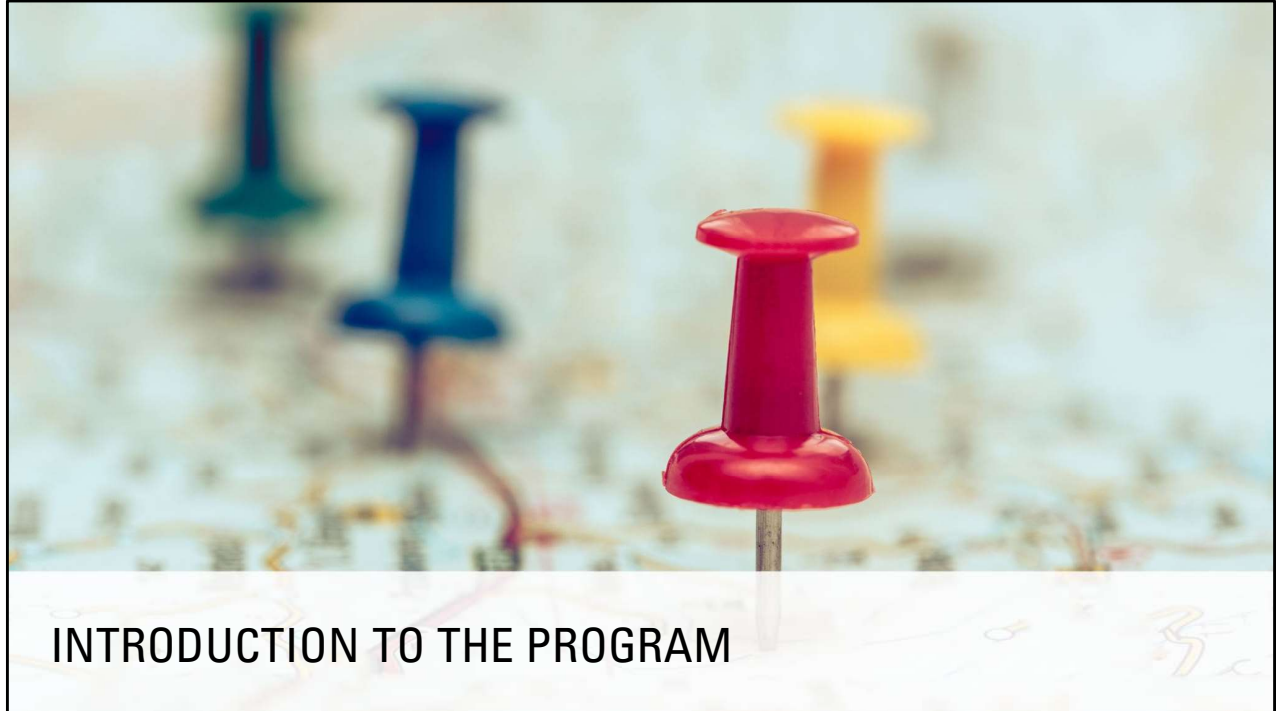


This one-day orientation agenda is intentionally sequenced to avoid overwhelming new hires, while still providing the essential compliance, benefits, and technology onboarding information needed on day one (Phelan, 2024). The program is grouped into major sections (Welcome & Culture, HR Essentials, Environment & Tools, and Department Overviews) to support clarity, engagement, and early connection with the organization. This approach helps new employees absorb information in manageable stages while also building confidence and belonging.

REGISTRATION, BREAKFAST, & LEADERSHIP ADDRESS



The orientation day begins with a short registration and check-in period. New hires will receive their name tag, orientation packet, and any required access materials. Access materials will be essential for the new hires during tech onboarding. This also ensures logistical needs are addressed early so the remainder of the day can focus on engagement, learning, and connection. After registration, employees will move into a welcome breakfast setting. This provides an environment where new hires can begin forming relationships with peers and orientation leaders. Research emphasizes that orientation is often a new employee's first opportunity to feel welcomed, supported, and included, and that early connection plays a key role in employee engagement and retention (Platt, 2023). To immediately establish connection and engagement, a brief welcome address will be delivered by firm leadership midway through breakfast. This leadership message will reinforce the organization's mission, values, and expectations, while helping employees understand how their work connects to the broader goals of the firm. Early role and expectation clarity is strongly tied to engagement and job satisfaction, making leadership involvement an important part of effective onboarding (Phelan, 2024).



This segment formally introduces the purpose of the orientation program and sets expectations for the day. While the welcome breakfast and leadership address are designed to build early connection, this section ensures new hires clearly understand what will be covered and how the day supports their transition into the firm. Structured orientation and onboarding programs are designed to help new employees acclimate effectively which reduces early uncertainty and setting the stage for long-term satisfaction and retention. Research shows that formal onboarding and orientation efforts can increase new employee satisfaction and retention outcomes beyond the first year of employment (Clisby, 2023). This shows the value of intentional program design rather than ad-hoc introductions. The program overview will close by walking employees through the major blocks of the day (Welcome & Culture, HR Essentials, Environment & Tools, Department Overviews, and Wrap-Up) so the agenda feels organized and manageable from the start.



The icebreaker activity will be a short “Networking Bingo” exercise designed to help new hires begin building relationships in a low-pressure and interactive way. Each participant will receive a bingo card with prompts such as professional background, interests, and general workplace-related experiences. New hires will move around the room, introduce themselves, and find coworkers who match each prompt in order to fill out their card. This activity is intentionally designed to promote early socialization, teamwork, and communication among employees who are meeting for the first time. Structured, interactive group activities is an effective method for improving collaboration and social connection in professional learning environments. Fusco et al. (2024) found that an educational game paired with structured reflection significantly improved teamwork and socialization outcomes, demonstrating that interactive activities can strengthen group connection early in the onboarding process.

POLICIES & PROCEDURES

Code of Conduct

Attendance,
Timekeeping, &
Scheduling

Confidentiality,
Client Data
Security, and
Privacy

Anti-Harassment,
Discrimination,
and Incident
Reporting

Workplace Safety

Internal
SharePoint
Walkthrough

This section gives new hires a clear overview of the key policies and procedures they will need to know right away. The goal is to cover the most important expectations early, explain where to find the full policies, and reduce confusion during the first few weeks. Topics include the firm's code of conduct, attendance and timekeeping expectations, confidentiality and client data security, anti-harassment and discrimination policies, and basic workplace safety procedures. Providing clear expectations early supports employee confidence and engagement, especially during the transition into a new role (Phelan, 2024). This section will also explain required compliance trainings (such as data security, harassment prevention, and ethics standards). These trainings help ensure both the new hire and the organization stay compliant, while reinforcing consistent expectations across the firm. Finally, there will be a quick walkthrough of the firm's internal SharePoint site. This is the company's central hub for all things, so new hires will know where to find resources such as policies, templates, key contacts, and department tools after orientation.

EMPLOYEE BENEFITS



Health, Dental, &
Vision Insurance



Retirement Plans
Overview



PTO, Holiday, &
Leave Policies



Wellness
Reimbursements &
Programs

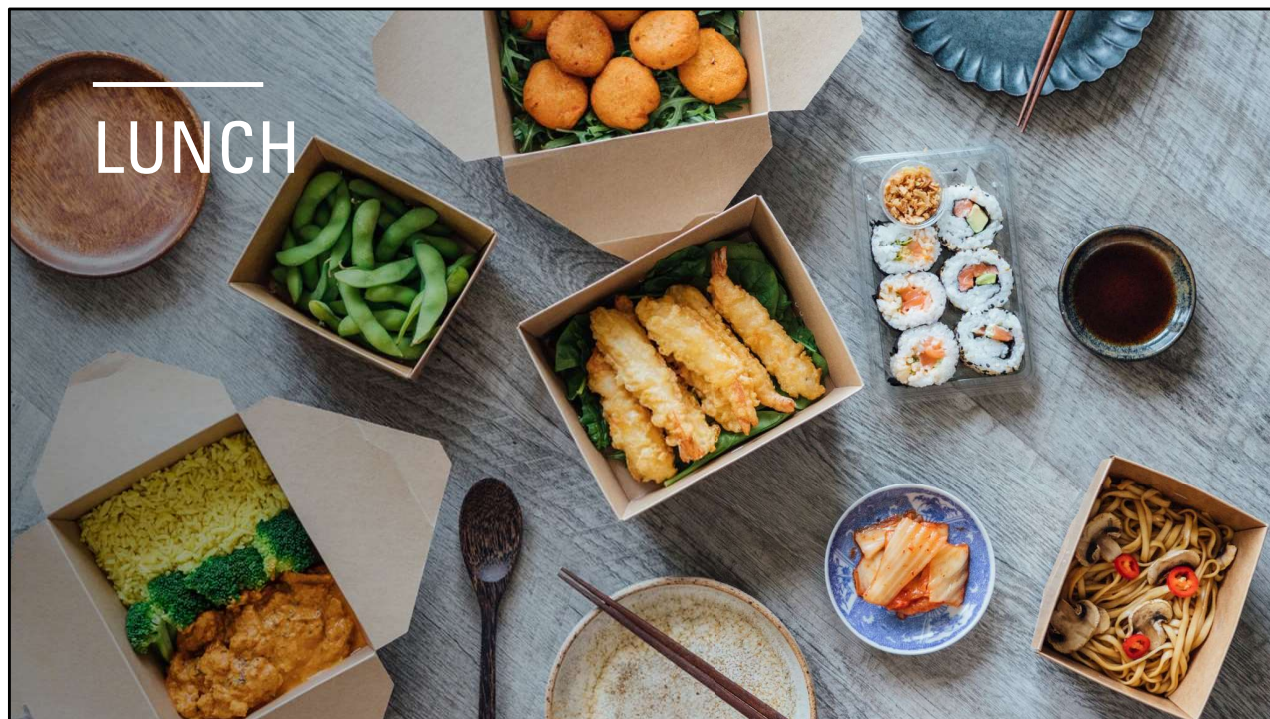


Professional
Development



Additional Benefits

New hires will be provided with an overview of the firm's benefits package and the resources available to support employee well-being, work-life balance, and long-term career growth. This portion of the day is also designed to be one of the most engaging and positive parts of orientation. Benefits are where we can clearly communicate what the firm invests in and how it supports employees both personally and professionally. In addition to covering the basics, this section highlights standout offerings: 5% retirement contribution with no employee match required, unlimited PTO, 12 company-wide disconnect days, and \$700 per year in wellness reimbursements. It will also emphasize professional development benefits that are especially relevant in a CPA firm: access to CPE-credited courses, paid study time for the CPA exam, and support for continued learning. Additional perks such as a volunteer day and enhanced parent benefits will be included to reinforce the firm's focus on employee well-being and retention. This is an opportunity to reinforce a positive first impression as strong orientation experiences help new hires feel connected to the organization and more motivated to stay (Platt, 2023). Before breaking for lunch, there will be time for a Q&A session with the orientation team, since the morning portion of the program includes a significant amount of information.

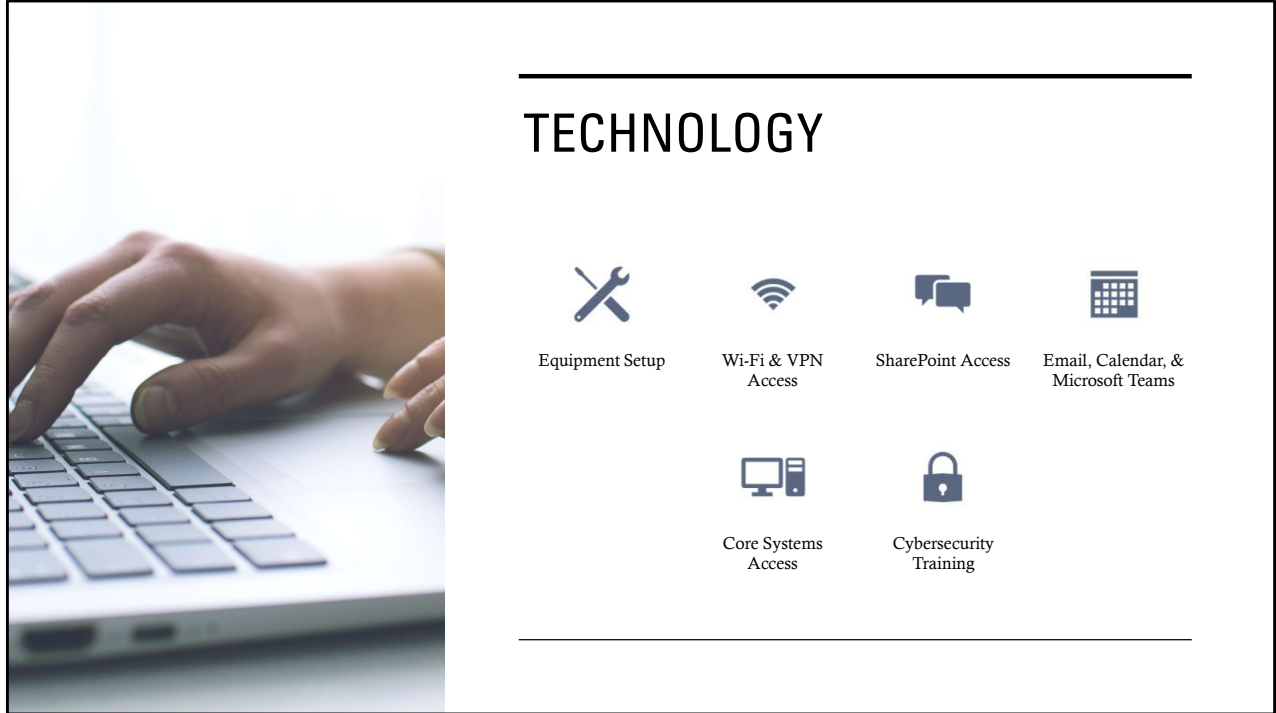


Lunch will be provided by ABC Company as part of the orientation day. This portion of the schedule is intentionally unstructured and free format. It gives new hires time to relax, reset, and socialize with in a more informal setting. This break also helps employees recharge before transitioning into the second half of the day, which focuses more heavily on tools, department overviews, and role-specific onboarding.

OFFICE TOUR



The office tour will include a walkthrough of the most commonly used areas so new hires feel comfortable navigating the workspace. The tour will begin with a general walkthrough of the office layout, followed by stops at the cafeteria area, lounge/break areas, and key conference rooms. During the conference room portion, new hires will be shown how rooms are labeled and how to reserve them for meetings. The tour will also include a walkthrough of where each department is located within the office. This is especially important so new hires can identify where teams sit and feel oriented. If the building is not overly large, all departments will be covered during the tour. The tour will conclude by ensuring each new hire knows how to return to their department, since they will be expected to transition back to their desk for tech onboarding immediately afterward.



After the office tour, new hires will return to their assigned department area. Their department head or direct manager will meet them and walk them to their desk, which will already be stocked with the necessary equipment (laptop, monitors, docking station, mouse/keyboard, and other required tools). A small onboarding gift (ABC Company swag) will also be waiting at their workstation as part of creating a strong first impression and helping new employees feel welcomed and valued from the start (Platt, 2023). New hires will then set up their workstation and connect to the firm's Wi-Fi and VPN. All setup instructions, login information, and temporary passwords will be included in the welcome packet provided during registration. This packet will also include guidance on how to access the company SharePoint site, navigate email/calendar/Microsoft Teams, and log into core systems such as timesheets, expense reporting, and other department tools. This portion of the day will conclude with required cybersecurity training modules to ensure employees understand the firm's expectations for protecting client information, using secure passwords, and identifying common threats such as phishing attempts.

DEPARTMENT OVERVIEW

- Meet Department Team Members
- Department Mission, Services, & Key Clients
- Team Structure & Communication Norms
- Role Expectations
- Workflows, Tools, and Tax Seasons Overview
- Q&A with Team Leadership



This portion of orientation allows new hires to meet directly with their assigned department and begin learning how their specific team operates. While the earlier sessions focus on the firm as a whole, this section helps employees connect the orientation experience to their day-to-day work environment. New hires will be introduced to department leadership, immediate team members, and key contacts they will work with regularly. During the department overview, managers will cover the department's mission, the services the team provides, and how the department supports the firm's overall goals. This section will also include a discussion of team structure, communication norms, common workflows, and the tools most frequently used. Because of how the CPA industry work fluctuates, this is also a good opportunity to provide an overview of seasonal expectations (such as tax season), so new hires understand how work may shift throughout the year. To reduce confusion and help employees feel included, department leaders will also explain common insider terminology, acronyms, and assumed knowledge in order to prevent new employees from experiencing uncertainty and exclusion. The department overview will end with time for questions and discussion so new hires can clarify expectations and feel more confident transitioning into their role.

WRAP-UP & NEXT STEPS



Key Takeaways



Resource Recap



Key Contacts Recap



Buddy Program Overview



Remaining Compliance Training Modules



First Weeks of Training

This final section brings all new hires back together as a group to close out the day and ensure everyone leaves with a clear understanding of what happens next. The wrap-up will begin with a brief review of key takeaways from the orientation program, reinforcing the most important points related to firm culture, policies, and available resources. Next, the orientation team will provide a resource recap, including where to find key information moving forward (such as the firm's SharePoint site). The group will also recap key contacts across the firm, including HR, IT support, payroll/benefits, and department leadership, so new hires know exactly who to reach out to when questions come up. This section will also include an overview of the buddy program. Each new hire will be paired with a more senior employee in their role who can help support their transition during the first six months. The buddy relationship is intended to provide a consistent point of contact for questions, guidance, and navigating team culture. The orientation team will also review any remaining compliance training modules that must be completed after day one, along with deadlines and where to access them. Finally, the program will end with an overview of what the next several weeks of training will look like. In most cases, new hires will spend the first two weeks completing hands-on learning with their team, including shadowing, workflow training, and additional learning modules.



To close the orientation program, the orientation team will thank all new hires for their time and participation throughout the day and recognize that it was a full schedule with a lot of information. New hires will be reminded that they are not expected to remember everything from day one. The main goal of today is to help them feel welcomed, understand the basics of how the firm operates, and know where to go when they need support. The session will end with a final welcome to ABC Company and a quick reminder that the firm is glad to have them on the team.

REFERENCES

- Clisby, T., Webber-Ritchey, K. J., Lattner, C., Spurlark, R. S., & Soco, C. (2023). Onboarding and Orientation Programs for Advanced Practice Providers (APPs) in Metropolitan Academic Medical Center Emergency Departments. *ABNFF Journal*, 2(1), 7–14.
- Fusco, N. M., Foltz-Ramos, K., Jacobsen, L. J., & Gambacorta, J. (2024). Educational game improves systems thinking, socialization, and teamwork among students of 13 health professions programs. *Journal of Interprofessional Care*, 38(1), 176–181. <https://doi-org.csuglobal.idm.oclc.org/10.1080/13561820.2023.2243307>
- Phelan, J. (2024). Onboarding New Employees -- Without Overwhelming Them. *Harvard Business Review Digital Articles*, 1–6.
- Platt, C. (2023). Orientation: Laying Out the Welcome Mat (or Not) for New Employees. *Virginia Libraries*, 67(1), 1–10. <https://doi-org.csuglobal.idm.oclc.org/10.21061/valib.v67i1.641>
-